

Configuring Pay Groups

User Guide

Access Limited Distribution

Payroll

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Document Control

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1. Overview

1.1. Purpose of the Guide

The purpose of this document is to provide guidance on how to configure Pay Groups.

Items covered include:

- How to add a Pay Group.
- How to edit a Pay Group.
- How to duplicate a Pay Group.
- How to delete a Pay Group.

1.2. What is a Pay Group?

A pay group is used for grouping employees that have the same pay frequency. This means that all the employees in a pay group are processed together for payment. Employees having common payment frequencies may be split over as many or as few pay groups as required.

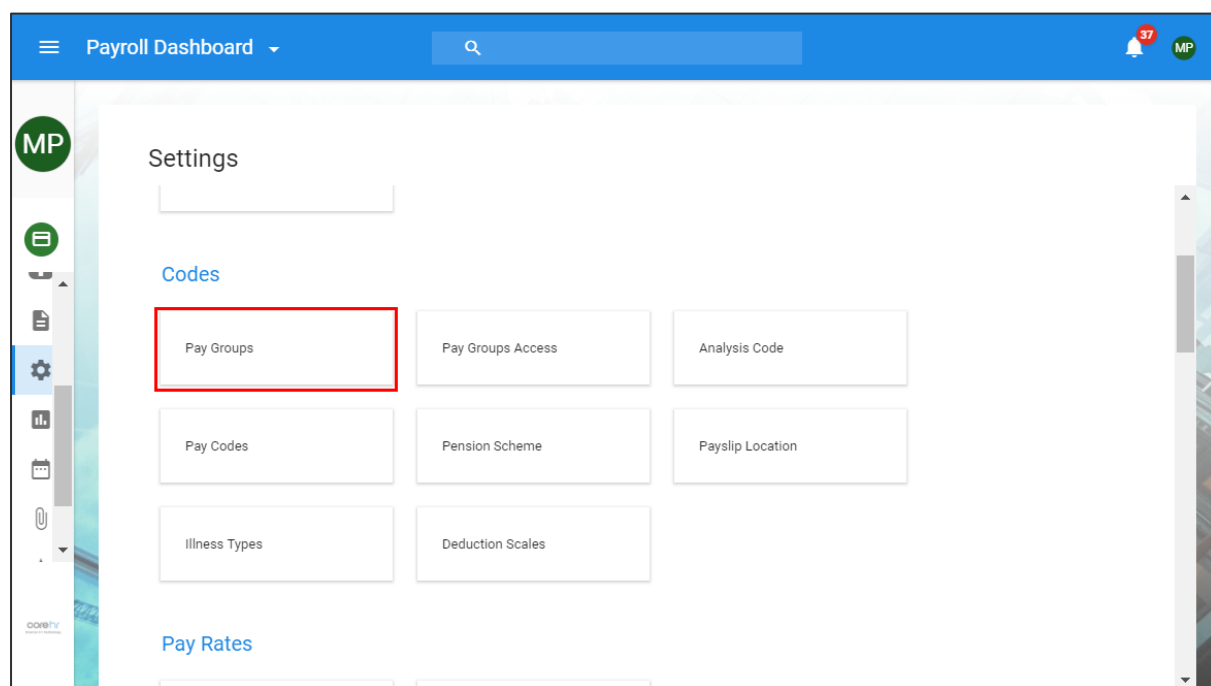
Every employee must be linked to a pay group, and each pay group must be linked to a company.

2. Provide Access to Pay Group Configuration

2.1. Access to Pay Groups on the Settings Tab

The following menu option is required for the user to access the Pay Groups screen from the Settings tab.

System	Menu Option
CorePortal Pay	Settings - Pay Groups

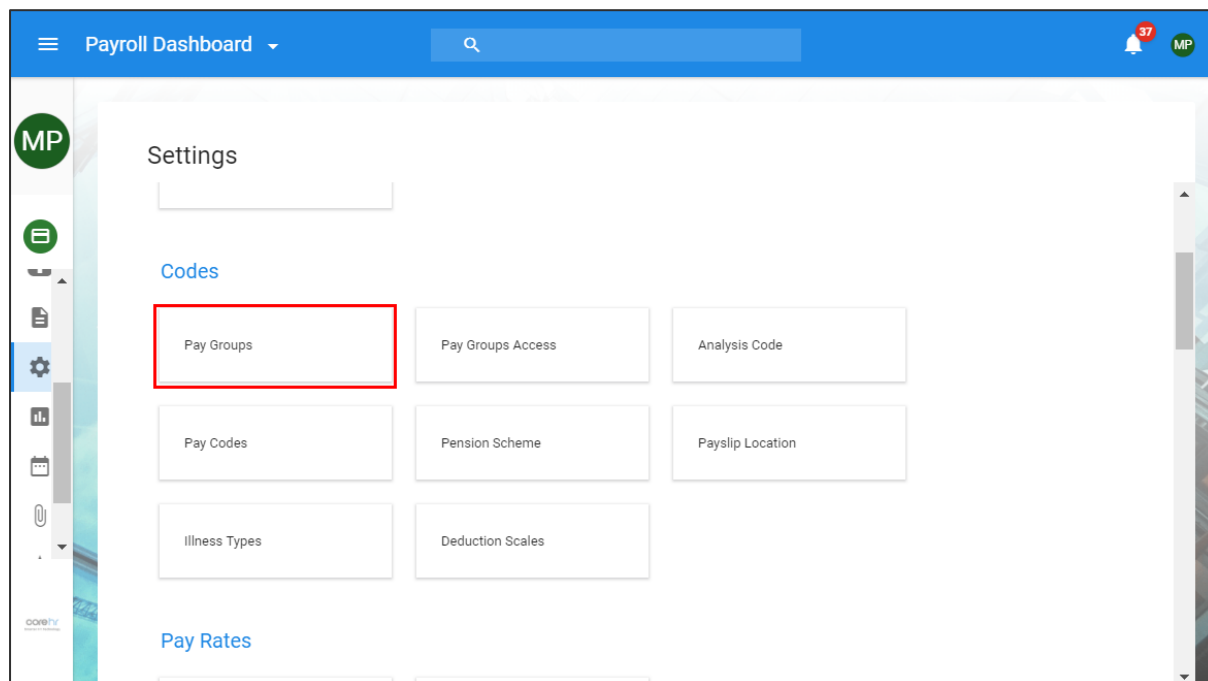


Status	Impact
Enabled	The user will have full view and edit access to the Pay Group screen.
Disabled	The user can still access the screen, but a 'You do not have access to this screen' message will be displayed.

3. Maintain Pay Groups

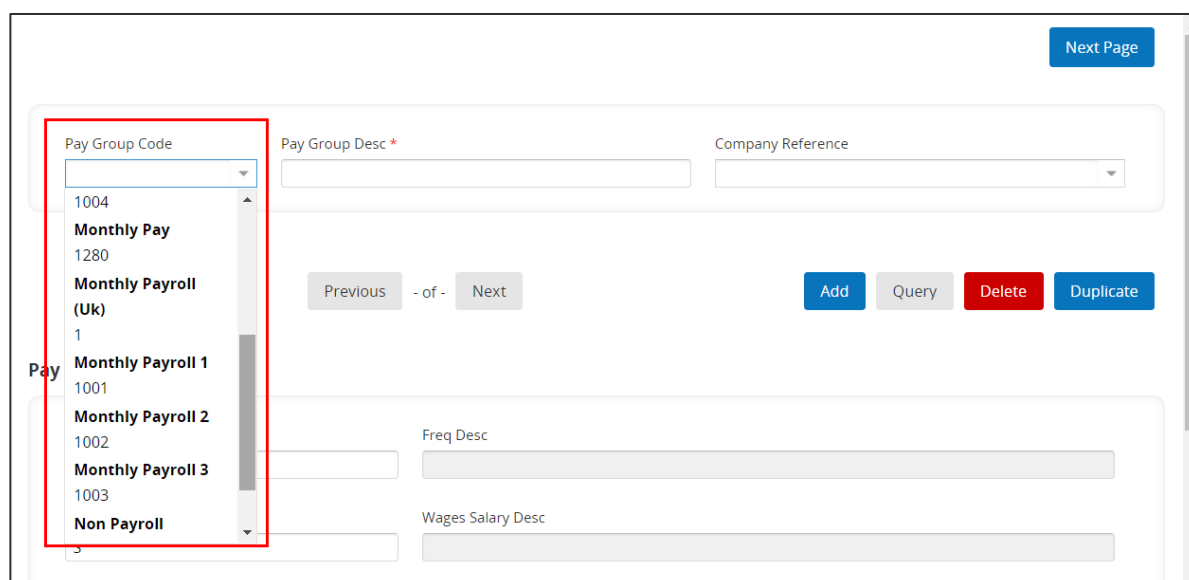
To add, edit, duplicate or delete a Pay Group:

Go to *Settings > Codes > Pay Groups*.



The *Pay Group* screen opens in query mode.

Select a pay group from the *Pay Group* drop-down menu to view the details.



There are many fields and indicators available in the set-up of pay groups. In the next section, we will focus on understanding the critical fields required in the set-up process.

3.1. Add a Pay Group

To add a new pay group:

1. Go to *Settings > Codes > Pay Groups*.
2. Click the blue **Add** button.
3. Complete at least all mandatory fields marked with a red asterisk.
4. Enter a unique code for the pay group.
5. Add a description of the new code in the *Description* field. (Maximum of 30 characters).
6. Populate the following fields.

Field	Description
Pay Frequency Indicator	W = Weekly, F = Fortnightly, M = Monthly, 4 = 4-Weekly or B = Bi-Monthly.
Wages/Salary Indicator	W = Wages or S = Salary.
Start Period	Enter a <i>Start Period</i> , e.g. 201901. The tax year start period.
Input Period	Enter an <i>Input Period</i> , e.g. 201926. This is determined by linking the input period specified to the calendar week on the payroll calendar.
Completed Input	Enter a <i>Completed Input</i> period, e.g. 201921. The last input period closed.
Completed Update	Enter a <i>Completed Update</i> period, e.g. 201917. The last payroll period closed.
Payroll Period	Enter the <i>Payroll Period</i> , e.g. 201926. The current payroll period.
Maximum Hours	Enter the maximum number of recorded hours an employee attached to this pay group can have worked. Employees who have worked chargeable hours greater than this value will be highlighted on the payroll observation report. (allowable range 0 – 9999).

Maximum Gross	Enter the maximum gross pay an employee attached to this pay group can receive within the pay period. Employees earning a gross amount above this value will be highlighted on the payroll observation report.
Maximum Nett	Enter the maximum nett pay an employee attached to this pay group can receive within the pay period. Employees earning a net amount above this value will be highlighted on the payroll observation report.
Pay Period Hours	Enter <i>Pay Period Hours</i>, i.e. the standards hours for a payroll period week. Enter the default/contracted hours in a period for this pay group. Note: For employees who do not work full time or whose hours are different, an override can be entered for each employee People Management. Pay Period hours are used when converting an employee's annual rate to the hourly to pay hours, e.g. basic hourly
Pay Period Days	Enter <i>Pay Period Days</i> , i.e. the standards days for a payroll period week. Enter the default days in a period for this pay group. These days are used when converting an employee's annual rate to the hourly or daily equivalent for the purpose of paying hours or days, e.g. Basic Hourly pay or overtime or daily pay.
Days in Year	Enter <i>Days in Year</i> , i.e. the days in the year for this pay group. This is used to convert annual rates to daily, e.g. 260 days in the year. This is used when calculating hourly pay for employees whose rate is set up as an annual figure.
	Using the above three parameters, the formula for converting from Annual to Hourly is as follows: - Annual Rate / Days in Year = Derived Daily Rate - Derived Daily Rate is multiplied by Days in Period = Derived Periodical Rate. - Derived Periodical Rate is divided by Pay Period Hours = Derived Hourly Rate.

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Next Page

Pay Group Code: 100 Pay Group Desc: ARCHIVED 100 Company Reference: Abc Solutions

Previous 1 of 1 Next Add Query Delete Duplicate

Pay Groups

Pay Frequency Indicator: M Freq Desc: MONTHLY

Wages/Salary Indicator: S Wages Salary Desc: SALARY

Start Period: 201401 Input Period: 201426 Completed Input: 201421 Completed Update: 201417 Payroll Period: 201426

Maximum Hours: 9999 Maximum Gross: 999999.00 Maximum Nett: 999999.00

Annual Allowance Ind. Validation Bypass Pay on Timesheet only Pay Leavers Allow Negative

This table provides a list of the option fields/indicators that can be configured.

Field / Indicator	Description
Annual Allowance Indicator	Tick if allowances are entered annually for this pay group. Applicable to value allowances only. By default, the system expects users to enter the periodic value when recording allowance values. If the annual allowance Indicator is enabled, then the daily rate is allowance value/pay group days in the year. Otherwise, it is allowance value/pay group days in the period.
Validation Bypass	Enable this to bypass the payroll validation run for this pay group.
Pay on Timesheet Only	Enable this if all employees are paid on a timesheet basis, i.e. nobody is paid a salary.
Pay Leaver	Enable if leavers are to be paid on input for this pay group.
Allow Negative	Enable this if negative nett pay is allowed for this pay group.
Payslip Message	Add text / message to appear on payslips for this pay group. Up to 6 lines can be added.

Field / Indicator	Description
Positive Input	Are employees in this pay group Salary only, Timesheet only or a mix of Salary and Timesheet employees? • If its Salary only then Positive Input should be blank. • If its Timesheet only then Positive Input should be Y. • If its a mix of Salary and Timesheet then Positive Input should be blank on the pay group but the employee Positive Input override facility on the Maintain Employee details screen should be ticked on for timesheet only employees.  Note: If Positive Input is enabled, then this means that an employee's salary will not generate, and permanent allowances will only generate if the employee has timesheets for the current period.
Retrospection Indicator	Enable if automatic retrospection is required for this pay group. For example, if an employee is retrospectively given an increase in salary. [Note: Overtime / Hourly calculations are handled by the Positive Input Retrospection process]
Employee Shift Indicator	Tick this if shift indicator is to be taken from employees for this pay group.
Un-process Zero Gross	Enter Y – to un-process. Enter N (Or leave blank) – to allow zero gross. Enter P – to partially process.

7. Select **Next Page**, to browse to page 2.

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Previous Page
➔
Next Page

Pay Group Code

Pay Group Desc *

Company Reference

Previous
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Next

Add
Query
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Pay Groups

Dormant Pay Group

PAYPATH PROCESSING DATE: (one of the following)

Day in Week
 THURSDAY

Day in Month

Day from E.O.M.

Sort Code

Bank Name

Validation Overtime Parameters

Gross High

Gross Low

Nett High

Nett Low

Order By

This table provides a list of the option fields/indicators that can be configured.

Field / Indicator	Description
Paypath Processing Date	Populate either the "Day in Week", "Day in Month" or "Day from E.O.M" depending on whether the payroll bank file sent to the bank for this pay group: 1. On a pre-determined day of the week that the file is being created in. 2. On a pre-determined date every month for monthly pay groups, e.g. 24th of every month. 3. X number of days from the end of the month for monthly pay groups, e.g. 4 days from the end of the month.
Gross High	Populate with -0.01, which is the Gross High threshold for the high/low report and ensures that all employees are captured on the report.

Field / Indicator	Description
Nett High	Populate with -0.01, which is the Nett High threshold for the high/low report and ensures that all employees are captured on the report.
Nett Low	Populate with -0.01, which is the Nett High threshold for the high/low report and ensures that all employees are captured on the report.
Order By	Populate with REFERENCE, which will be the default order for the reports on the View Gross to Nett screen.
Advance Pay F/L	Populate with L, as baseline configuration will not require advance payment for holidays.
Offset Days	The difference in days, between the weekend date on the payroll company calendar, and the weekend date on the pay group. This does not apply to monthly pay groups as the period end date for a monthly pay group is always the last day of the month as per the financial period.

8. Select **Next**, to browse to page 3.

Field / Indicator	Description
Print Payslip	Are payslips printed for all employees in the pay group?
Salary Pay Code	Enter the pay code against which salaries will be recorded.
Pay Salary and Allowances on Days Worked	This attribute refers to how salary and allowances are paid on days worked. For example, if a salaried employee started on the 10th of October 2019, earning 30,000 annually, how would you calculate their pay for October? Option A: 16 working days between 10th and 31st October 2019. Therefore the amount Due = $((30,000/260) * 16 = 1,846.15$ i.e. (Annual Salary / # Working days in the year) x Days worked in the month. Option B: 22 calendar days between 10th and 31st October 2019. Therefore the amount Due = $((30,000/12) / 31) * 23 =$

Field / Indicator	Description
	1,854.84 i.e. (Monthly Salary / # Calendar days in the month) x Calendar Days between start date and the end of the month. Note: This rule will also apply to mid-month changes in salary allowances and also for calculating the salary of a mid-month leaver.

9. Select **Save**.

The screenshot shows a configuration form for a pay group. It includes the following fields and controls:

- Payable Ord. Grp No: [Text input]
- Vote: [Dropdown menu]
- Auto Increment: [Text input with 'N']
- GL Code: [Dropdown menu]
- Divisor: [Text input]
- Legacy Supplementary Run: [Toggle switch]
- Turn Off No Associated Timesheets: [Toggle switch]
- Periodic Employee Hours: [Toggle switch]
- Payslip Tolerance: [Text input]
- Shared Services: [Toggle switch]
- PSPR Exclusion Indicator: [Toggle switch]
- Social Welfare Offset Days: [Text input]

At the bottom left is a 'Cancel' button. At the bottom right is a 'Save' button, which is highlighted with a red box and a red arrow pointing to it.

3.2. Edit a Pay Group



Note:

Pay Groups should not be edited mid payroll run. Care should always be taken when editing pay groups.

To edit a pay group:

1. Go to *Settings > Codes > Pay Groups*.
2. Select a pay group from the drop-down menu.
3. Click on the field(s) to be amended.
4. Overwrite the current data with the new required data.
5. Click the green **Save** button.

3.3. Duplicate a Pay Group

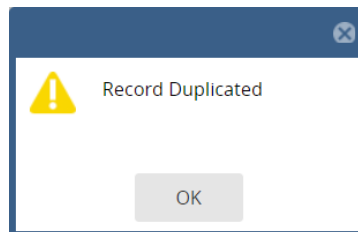
Pay Groups can be duplicated and then edited. This process can be used to save time when configuring multiple new pay groups.

To duplicate a Pay Group:

1. Go to: *Settings > Codes > Pay Groups*.
2. Select a pay group from the *Pay Group* drop-down menu.
3. Press enter to populate the details in the tabs below.
4. Click on the blue **Duplicate** button.



5. A pop up is generated when the record is duplicated.



The system will not allow you to save a duplicate. The new pay group must be amended.

6. Alter (at very least) *Pay Group Code* and description.
7. Click the green **Save** button.

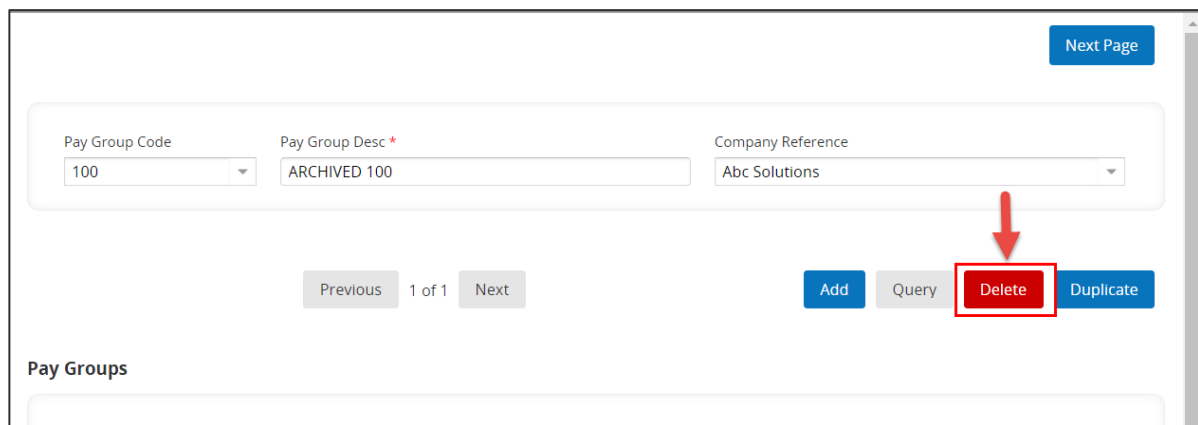
3.4. Delete a Pay Group

Note:

Pay Groups should not be deleted mid payroll run. Care should always be taken when deleting pay groups. This delete option should only be used if a new pay group has been set up in error. Pay Groups linked to current employees or which have been used to process payroll should not be deleted.

To delete a Pay Group:

1. Go to *Settings > Codes > Pay Groups*.
2. Select a Pay Group from the *Pay Group* drop-down menu.
3. Press enter to populate the details in the tabs below.
4. Click on the blue **Delete** button.



The screenshot displays the 'Pay Groups' configuration page. At the top right is a 'Next Page' button. Below it are three input fields: 'Pay Group Code' with a dropdown menu showing '100', 'Pay Group Desc' with a text field containing 'ARCHIVED 100', and 'Company Reference' with a dropdown menu showing 'Abc Solutions'. Below these fields are navigation buttons: 'Previous', '1 of 1', and 'Next'. To the right of these are four action buttons: 'Add', 'Query', 'Delete', and 'Duplicate'. A red arrow points to the 'Delete' button, which is also highlighted with a red rectangular border. Below the buttons is a section titled 'Pay Groups' with a table that is partially visible.

5. Click the green **Save** button.